Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI61 61% Fe Fines RMB/t

801
4 0.53%
Mar 23rd, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

920
4.69 0.51%
Mar 23rd, 2026

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

729
2 0.33%
Mar 23rd, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI61 61% Fe Fines USD/dmt

107.00
0.80 0.76%
Mar 23rd, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

125.96
1.26 1.01%
Mar 23rd, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

900
-10 -1.10%
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2605 (May) RMB/t (3pm close)

819.00
3.50 0.43%
Mar 23rd, 2026 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
March 26 USD/dmt

108.20
-0.05 -0.05%
Mar 23rd, 2026 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2605 (Jan) RMB/t

3154
31 0.99%
Mar 23rd, 2026 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

30.53
0.07 0.2%
Mar 20th, 2026

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

11.77
-0.51 -4.1%
Mar 20th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3154
-10 -0.32%
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

156.39
0.98 0.63%
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

15.16
0.00 0.00%
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3275
-7 -0.21%
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Mar 23rd, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	801	4	0.5%	787	828	683	1063	107.86	0.59	0.6%	102.62	108.09	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	729	2	0.3%	694	727	610	963	98.89	0.33	0.3%	91.01	95.59	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	920	5	0.5%	897	938	794	1175	124.49	0.65	0.5%	117.37	122.97	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Mar 23rd, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	107.00	0.80	0.76%	103.52	109.05	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	125.96	1.26	1.01%	115.74	123.69	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Dalian iron ore futures exhibited a volatile but firm upward trend today, with the most-traded I2605 contract concluding the session at 819 RMB per tonne, marking a 0.92% increase from the prior trading day. In the physical market, spot prices registered a modest gain of approximately 1-2 RMB. Trading houses were reasonably active in offering quotes, whereas steel mills maintained a cautious approach to procurement, resulting in subdued transaction volumes.

From a fundamental's perspective, SMM data indicates that global iron ore shipments last week totalled 33.63 million tonnes, a slight week-on-week increase of 5.2%, while arrivals at Chinese ports contracted by 3.5% to 27.14 million tonnes.

When factoring in the decelerated pace of port stock accumulation and increased port offtake, the previously oversupplied state of the market has shown short-term improvement. Concurrently, demand is recovering as blast furnaces progressively resume operations, causing market fundamentals to become increasingly bullish. On the market intelligence front, the prevailing trend remains uncertain due to a stalemate in long-term contract negotiations, which has prompted most investment capital to adopt a wait-and-see stance. Despite this, overall bullish sentiment remains strong. Therefore, it is anticipated that iron ore prices will continue to fluctuate at an elevated level throughout the week.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	900	-10	-1.1%	895	952	820	1210	116.57	-1.26	-1.07%	112.25	119.67	102.77	153.57

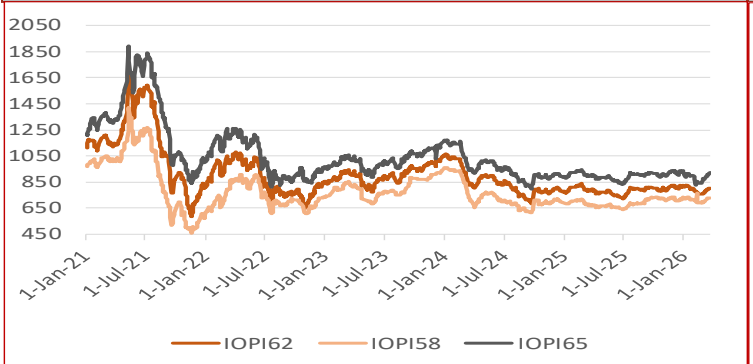
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	964	4.0%	859	1226	139.79	4.06%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	975	0.0%	880	1300	141.39	0.06%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	745	0.7%	690	970	108.03	0.74%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	997	4.4%	878	1294	144.58	4.47%	122.53	182.16

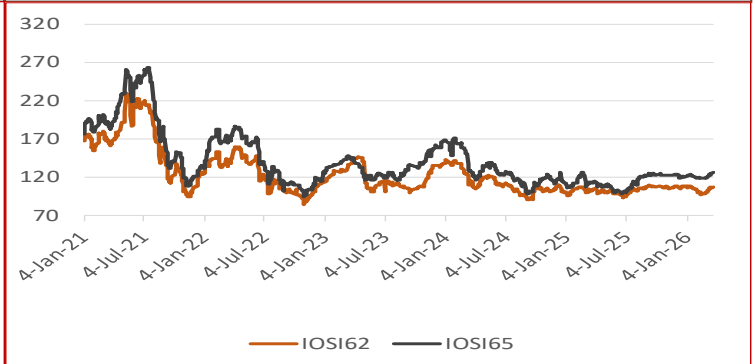
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	870.51	1.45%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 23rd, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	805	798	810	769	787	783	828	105.46	100.24	107.43	102.60	102.62	101.99	108.09
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	720	716	719	699	694	689	727	95.02	94.72	96.04	93.94	91.01	90.33	95.59
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	917	925	900	852	897	892	938	120.64	122.17	119.85	114.11	117.37	116.79	122.97

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 23rd, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	106.33	105.42	106.27	99.65	103.52	102.85	109.05
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	122.46	121.09	121.51	118.61	115.74	114.92	123.69

FREIGHT RATES

Mar 20th, 2026		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	11.77	-0.51	-4.1%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	30.53	0.07	0.2%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	880	864	875	844	895	891	952	114.52	110.83	111.50	108.31	112.25	111.83	119.67

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Mar 23rd, 2026		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-72	-8.99%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	119	14.88%

Mar 23rd, 2026		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	18.95	17.71%

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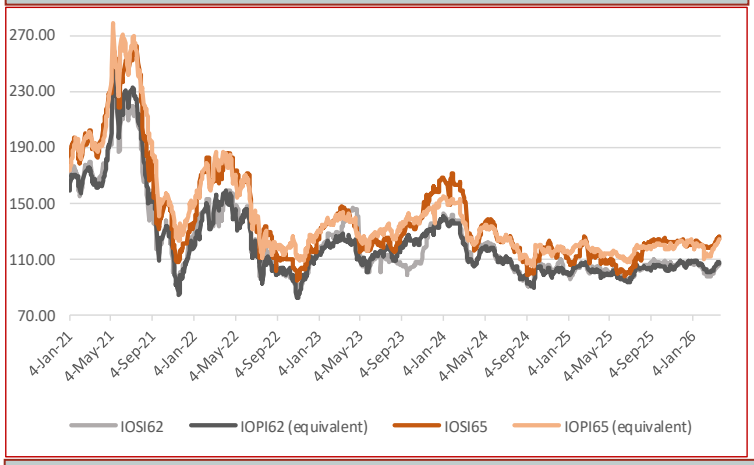
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Mar 23rd, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	763	5	-38
SIMEC Fines	789	5	-12
PB Fines	810	5	9
Newman Fines	807	5	6
MAC Fines	801	5	0
Jimblebar Blended Fines	719	5	-82
Carajas Fines	893	5	92
Brazilian SSF	874	5	73
Brazilian Blend Fines	867	5	66
RTX Fines	678	5	-123
West Pilbara Fines	800	5	-1

Mar 23rd, 2026	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	100.00	0.90	-7.00
SIMEC Fines	96.00	0.65	-11.00
PB Fines	107.00	1.10	0.00
Newman Fines	104.00	0.65	-3.00
MAC Fines	103.80	1.45	-3.20
Jimblebar Blended Fines	96.60	1.40	-10.40
Carajas Fines	126.10	0.90	19.10
Brazilian SSF	103.10	0.90	-3.90
Brazilian Blend Fines	114.30	1.25	7.30
RTX Fines	96.80	0.80	-10.20
West Pilbara Fines	98.70	0.50	-8.30

Mar 23rd, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	680	3	-49
FMG Blended Fines	741	3	12
Robe River	738	3	9
Western Fines	697	3	-32
Atlas Fines	743	3	14
Yandi	719	3	-10

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	16.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	60.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	66.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	30.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	9.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	11.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	20.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	19.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	25.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	25.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	7.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	7.75	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	6.50	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.75	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-20.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-18.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-3.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	0.00	Jingtang	-16.00	1.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-18.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-20.00	0.00

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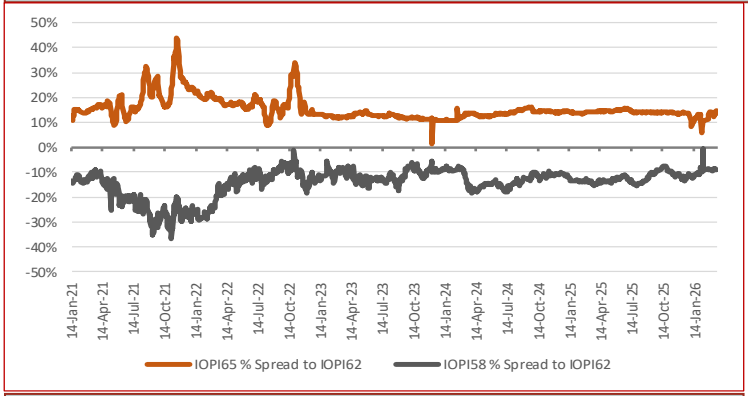
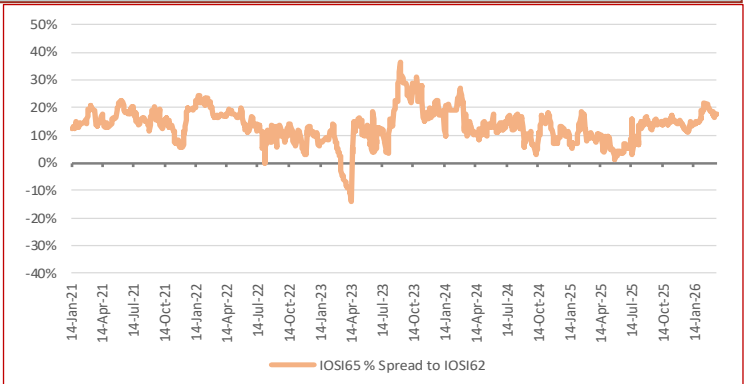
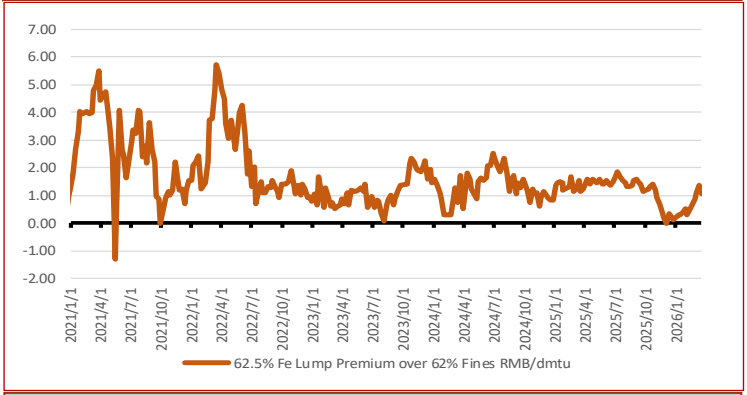
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

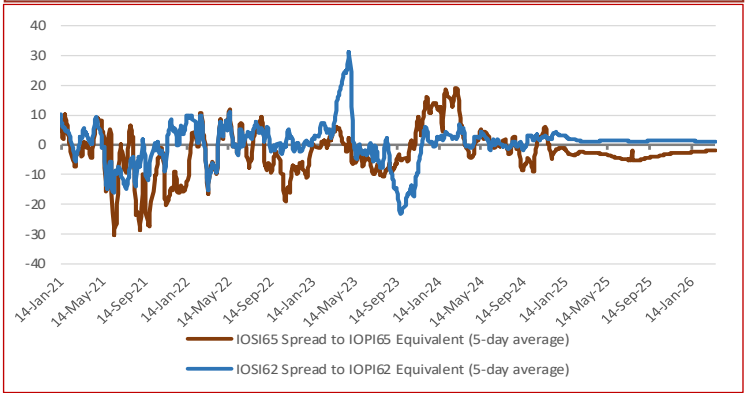




WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)

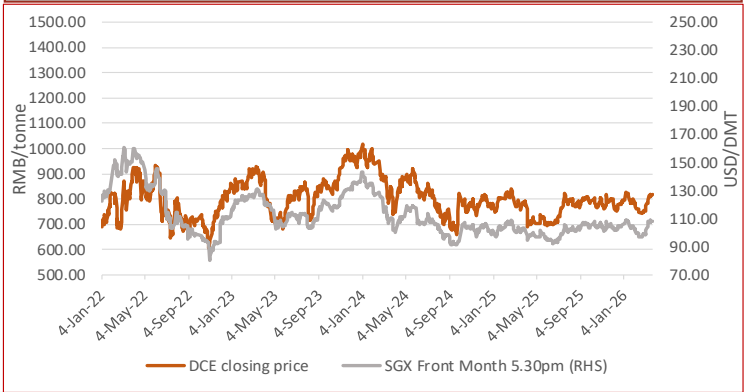


IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)

FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

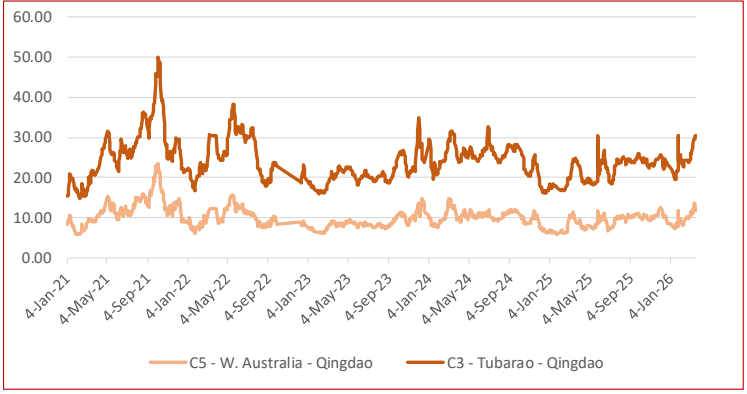
Week Ending Mar 20th, 2026

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	18.47	2.61%	8.29	18.47
Qingdao	32.30	0.34%	22.28	34.83
Caofeidian	17.68	0.91%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	12.25	-2.16%	6.64	12.52
Rizhao	12.71	2.33%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	156.39	0.63%	105.01	166.39

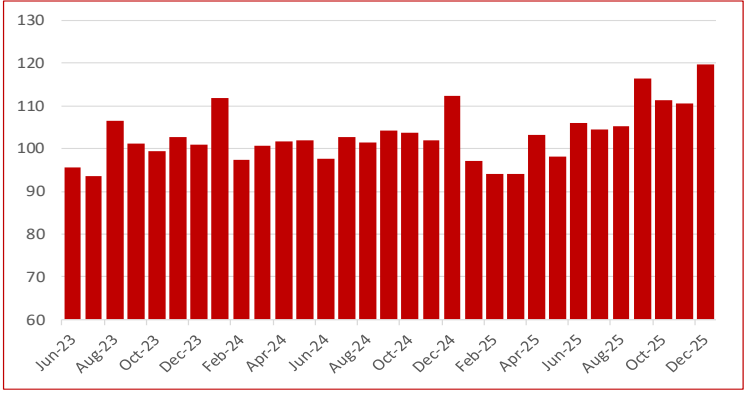
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Mar 23rd, 3pm close			Mar 23rd, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2605	Change	Change %	Mar. 26	Change	Change %
Closing Price	819.00	3.50	0.43%	108.20	-0.05	-0.05%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	26.33	1.60	6.49%	9.30	2.21	31.08%
Open positions ('000 lots)	44.19	-0.83	-1.83%	48.39	-1.15	-2.33%
Day Low	812.5	12.50	1.56%	107.45	1.25	1.18%
Day High	826.0	7.50	0.92%	108.65	0.20	0.18%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2026/03/20	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,154	-10	-0.32%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,351	-10	-0.30%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,275	-7	-0.21%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,783	-4	-0.10%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,383	7	0.20%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,053	17	0.41%
Colour Coated Plate	6,350	50	0.79%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

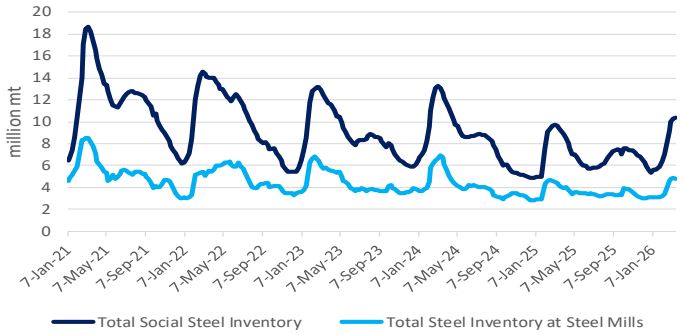
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	107.27	0.49	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,605	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,480	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,582	19	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,144	22	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-14	-22	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,213	14	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	77	-14	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

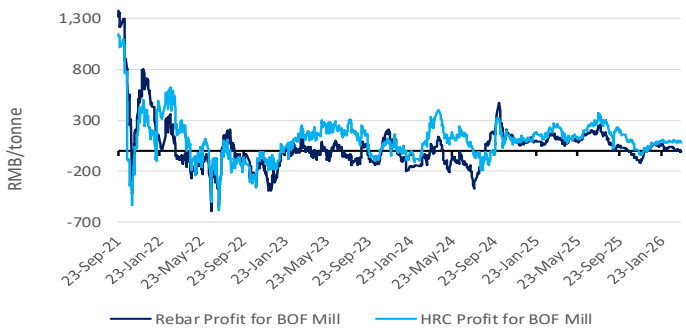
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

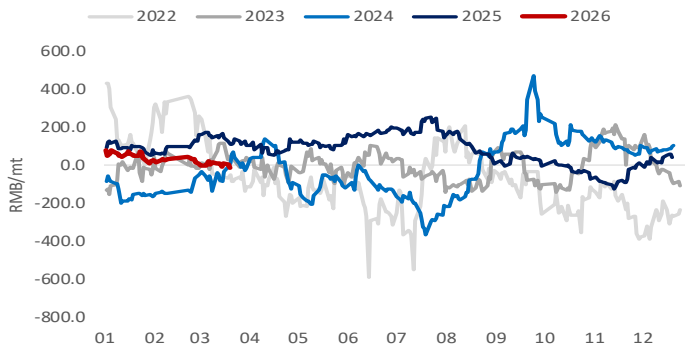
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



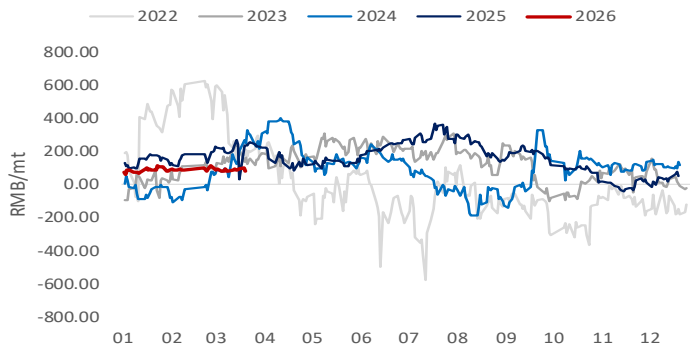
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



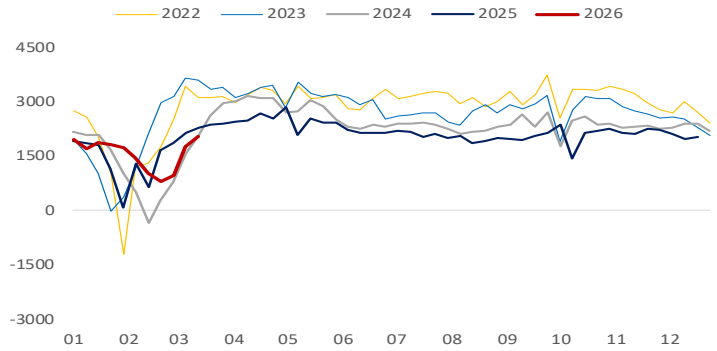
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



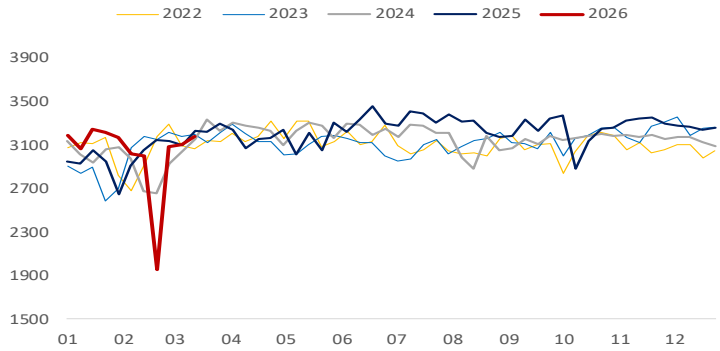
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



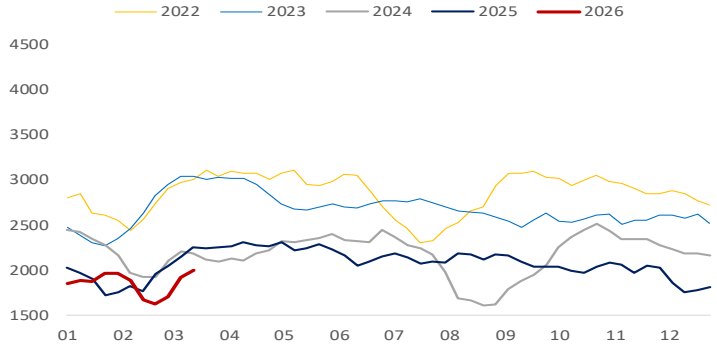
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



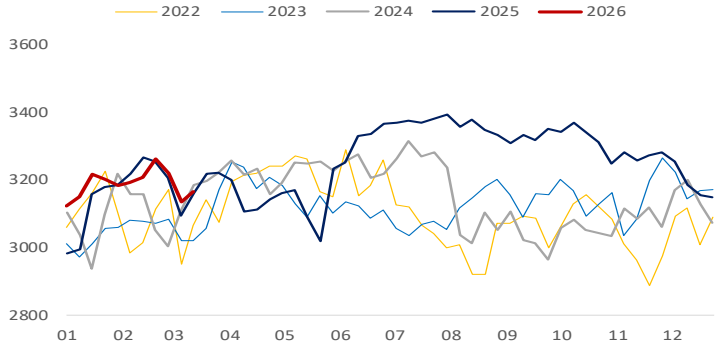
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Mar 23rd, 2026	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Mar 23rd, 2026	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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